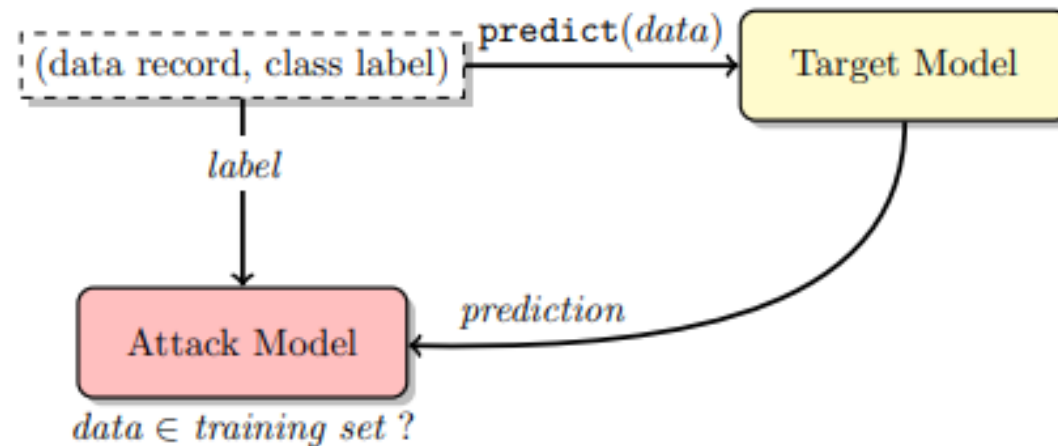


# Membership Inference Attacks Against Machine Learning Models

Reza Shokri, Marco Stronati, Congzheng Song, Vitaly Shmatikov

# Membership inference

- Given a machine learning model and a record, determine whether this record was used as part of the model's training dataset or not.



# What we have?

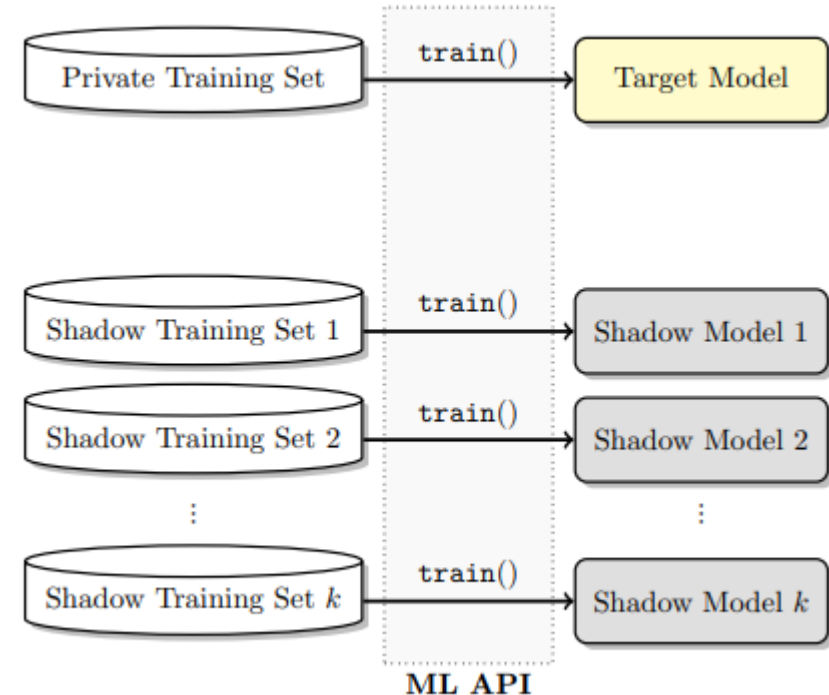
- Training data's info:
  - Another part of training data. (1)
  - Training data's distribution / noisy training data. (2)
  - Statistic infos. (3)
  - Nothing. (4)
- Model's info:
  - Model's structure and training algorithm. (1)
  - Black-box query access to the target model. (2)

# Key point: Mimic

- We purposed to mimic target model's behavior.
- **Shadow model !!!**

For each class  $i$ , we plan to train a shadow model  $f_{shadow}^i()$ . Each shadow model trained on the data distribution of class  $i$  and try to predict if one instance is in its training set (binary classification problem).

**Why not just one shadow model ?**



# Shadow models' food

- Everything seems easy now...
- but how to obtain the training data of shadow model?
- We need to ensure the synthetic data should be from the same distribution of private training data.
- Purposed method:
  - Model-based synthesis
  - Statistics-based synthesis
  - Noisy real data

# Model-based synthesis

- What we have:
  - Data aspect: nothing.
  - Model aspect: black-box query access (even can get logits!)
- Genetic algorithm...
  - After we query the model an img => the prediction label and its logits.
  - Walk an random step.
  - $y_c > \textit{current best}$ , Update.
    - $\textit{current best} > \textit{acceptable threshold}$ , Return
  - Else keep random.

# Framework

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**Algorithm 1** Data synthesis using the target model

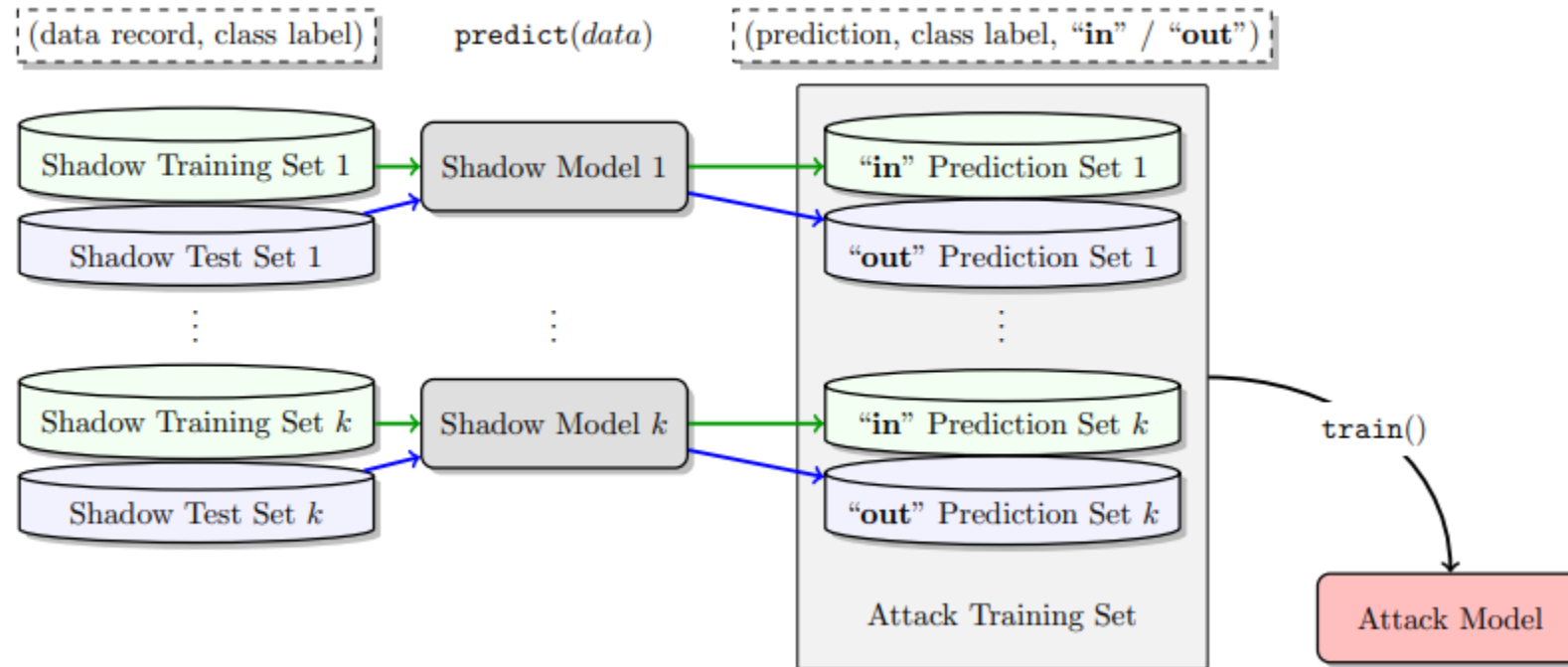
---

```
1: procedure SYNTHESIZE(class :  $c$ )
2:    $\mathbf{x} \leftarrow \text{RANDRECORD}()$   $\triangleright$  initialize a record randomly
3:    $y_c^* \leftarrow 0$ 
4:    $j \leftarrow 0$ 
5:    $k \leftarrow k_{\max}$ 
6:   for iteration =  $1 \dots \text{iter}_{\max}$  do
7:      $\mathbf{y} \leftarrow f_{\text{target}}(\mathbf{x})$   $\triangleright$  query the target model
8:     if  $y_c \geq y_c^*$  then  $\triangleright$  accept the record
9:       if  $y_c > \text{conf}_{\min}$  and  $c = \arg \max(\mathbf{y})$  then
10:        if  $\text{rand}() < y_c$  then  $\triangleright$  sample
11:          return  $\mathbf{x}$   $\triangleright$  synthetic data
12:        end if
13:      end if
14:       $\mathbf{x}^* \leftarrow \mathbf{x}$ 
15:       $y_c^* \leftarrow y_c$ 
16:       $j \leftarrow 0$ 
17:    else
18:       $j \leftarrow j + 1$ 
19:      if  $j > \text{rej}_{\max}$  then  $\triangleright$  many consecutive rejects
20:         $k \leftarrow \max(k_{\min}, \lceil k/2 \rceil)$ 
21:         $j \leftarrow 0$ 
22:      end if
23:    end if
24:     $\mathbf{x} \leftarrow \text{RANDRECORD}(\mathbf{x}^*, k)$   $\triangleright$  randomize  $k$  features
25:  end for
26:  return  $\perp$   $\triangleright$  failed to synthesize
27: end procedure
```

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Why this works ???

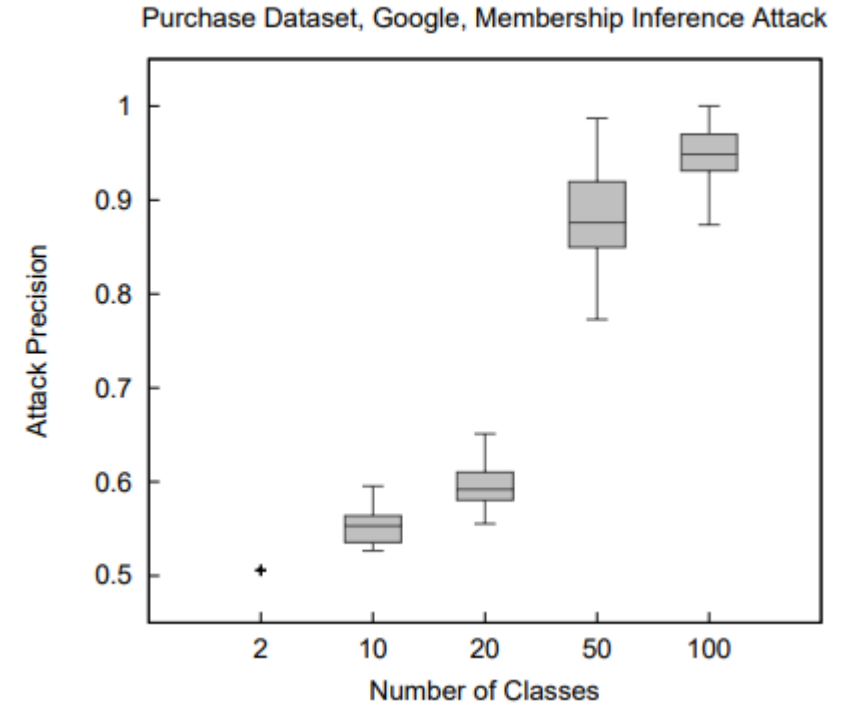
# Whole framework





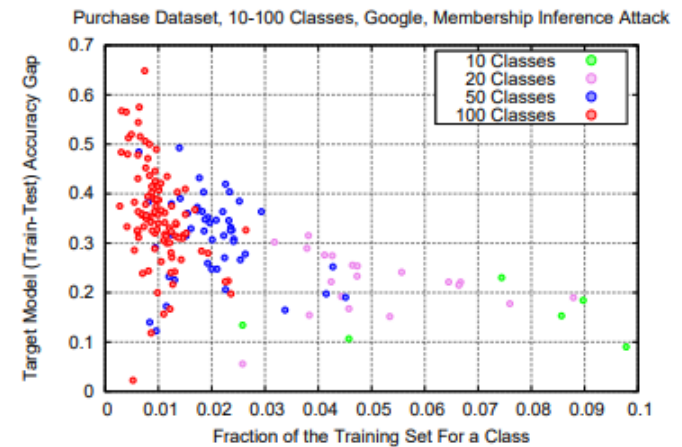
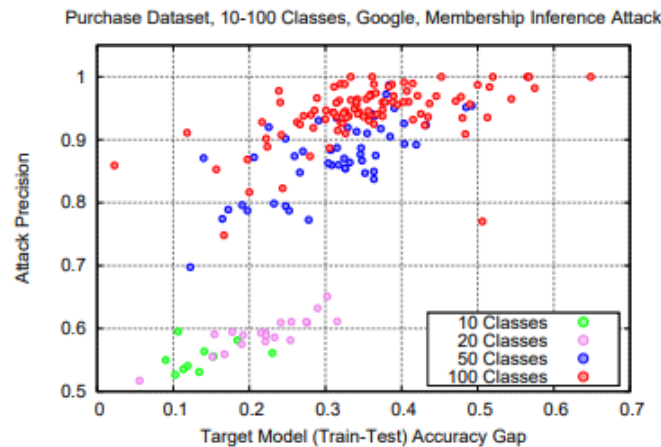
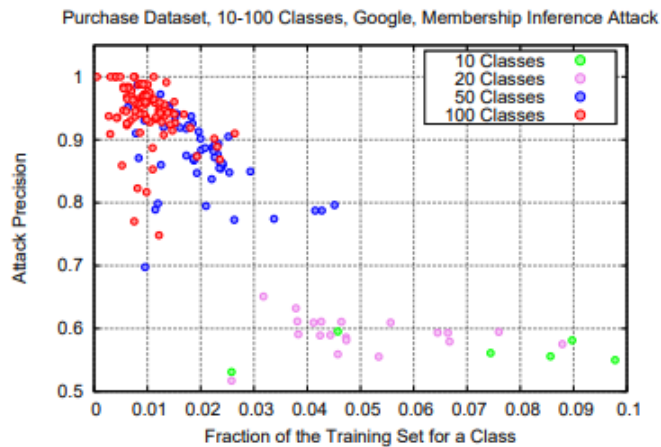
# Attack results

| <i>Dataset</i>    | <i>Training Accuracy</i> | <i>Testing Accuracy</i> | <i>Attack Precision</i> |
|-------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------|-------------------------|
| Adult             | 0.848                    | 0.842                   | 0.503                   |
| MNIST             | 0.984                    | 0.928                   | 0.517                   |
| Location          | 1.000                    | 0.673                   | 0.678                   |
| Purchase (2)      | 0.999                    | 0.984                   | 0.505                   |
| Purchase (10)     | 0.999                    | 0.866                   | 0.550                   |
| Purchase (20)     | 1.000                    | 0.781                   | 0.590                   |
| Purchase (50)     | 1.000                    | 0.693                   | 0.860                   |
| Purchase (100)    | 0.999                    | 0.659                   | 0.935                   |
| TX hospital stays | 0.668                    | 0.517                   | 0.657                   |



# Other thoughts

- Overfitting => leaking data ?
  - “The more overfitted a model, the more it leaks—but only for models of the same type.”
- Bad generalization, non-diverse data => leaking data?



# Privacy in Pharmacogenetics:

An End-to-End Case Study of Personalized Warfarin Dosing

Matthew Fredrikson\*, Eric Lantz\*, Somesh Jha\*, Simon Lin†, David  
Page\*, Thomas Ristenpart\*

# Model inversion

- Given a model trained to predict a specific variable, uses it to make predictions of unintended (sensitive) attributes used as input to the model (i.e., an attack on the privacy of attributes).

$f(x)$

| age   | height | weight | race  | history | vkorc1 | cyp2c9 | dose |
|-------|--------|--------|-------|---------|--------|--------|------|
| 50-59 | 176.53 | 144.2  | white |         |        |        | 42.0 |
| 50-59 | 176.53 | 144.2  | white |         |        |        | 42.0 |
| 50-59 | 176.53 | 144.2  | white |         |        |        | 42.0 |

|      |          |
|------|----------|
| 49.7 | $p=0.23$ |
| 42.0 | $p=0.75$ |
| 39.2 | $p=0.01$ |

# What we have?

- Training data's info:
  - Prior prob of prediction labels.
  - Target person's other public info.
  - Target person's prediction.
- Model's info:
  - Black-box query access.
  - Info about model's performance  $\pi(y, y') = \mathbf{Pr} [\mathbf{z}_y = y | f(\mathbf{z}_x) = y']$

# Case #1: Perfect model

Bayes rule:

$$\Pr[x_t | \mathbf{x}_K, y] = \frac{\Pr[x_t, \mathbf{x}_K, y]}{\Pr[\mathbf{x}_K, y]} = \frac{\sum_{\mathbf{x}' \in \hat{\mathbf{X}}: \mathbf{x}'_t = x_t} p(\mathbf{x}', y)}{\sum_{\mathbf{x}' \in \hat{\mathbf{X}}} p(\mathbf{x}', y)}$$

Maximum Entropy Principle:

$$p(\mathbf{x}, y) = p(y) \cdot \prod_{1 \leq i \leq d} p(\mathbf{x}_i)$$

MAP estimate:

$$\begin{aligned} \Pr[x_t | \mathbf{x}_K, y] &= \frac{\sum_{\mathbf{x}' \in \hat{\mathbf{X}}: \mathbf{x}'_t = x_t} p(y) \prod_i p(\mathbf{x}'_i)}{\sum_{\mathbf{x}' \in \hat{\mathbf{X}}} p(y) \prod_i p(\mathbf{x}'_i)} \\ &\propto \sum_{\mathbf{x}' \in \hat{\mathbf{X}}: \mathbf{x}'_t = x_t} \prod_i p(\mathbf{x}'_i) \end{aligned}$$

# Case #2: Imperfect model

Model's performance function:

$$\pi(y, y') = \mathbf{Pr} [z_y = y | f(z_x) = y']$$

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{Pr} [x_t | \mathbf{x}_K, y^\alpha, f] &= \frac{\sum_{\mathbf{x}' \in \hat{\mathbf{X}}: \mathbf{x}'_t = x_t} \mathbf{Pr} [\mathbf{x}', y, f(\mathbf{x}')] }{\sum_{\mathbf{x}' \in \hat{\mathbf{X}}} \mathbf{Pr} [\mathbf{x}', y, f(\mathbf{x}')] } \\ &= \frac{\sum_{\mathbf{x}' \in \hat{\mathbf{X}}: \mathbf{x}'_t = x_t} \mathbf{Pr} [y | \mathbf{x}', f(\mathbf{x}')] p(\mathbf{x}') }{\sum_{\mathbf{x}' \in \hat{\mathbf{X}}} \mathbf{Pr} [\mathbf{x}', y, f(\mathbf{x}')] } \\ &\propto \sum_{\mathbf{x}' \in \hat{\mathbf{X}}: \mathbf{x}'_t = x_t} \pi_{y, f(\mathbf{x}')} (\prod_i p(\mathbf{x}'_i)) \end{aligned}$$

# Model Inversion Attacks that Exploit Confidence Information and Basic Countermeasures

Matt Fredrikson, Somesh Jha, Thomas Ristenpart



# Drawbacks of Model inversion

- UNK features / Continuous features



- Computational infeasible while *dim* is large (image level)

# How to achieve this?

- Gradient Descent!
- We started our attack image  $\mathbf{x}$  from scratch.
- During every iteration:

$$\mathbf{x}_i \leftarrow \text{PROCESS}(\mathbf{x}_{i-1} - \lambda \cdot \nabla c(\mathbf{x}_{i-1}))$$

- We keep following the gradient until meets the confidence threshold.

# Detailed framework

---

**Algorithm 1** Inversion attack for facial recognition models.

---

```
1: function MI-FACE( $label, \alpha, \beta, \gamma, \lambda$ )
2:    $c(\mathbf{x}) \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} 1 - \tilde{f}_{label}(\mathbf{x}) + \text{AUXTERM}(\mathbf{x})$ 
3:    $\mathbf{x}_0 \leftarrow \mathbf{0}$ 
4:   for  $i \leftarrow 1 \dots \alpha$  do
5:      $\mathbf{x}_i \leftarrow \text{PROCESS}(\mathbf{x}_{i-1} - \lambda \cdot \nabla c(\mathbf{x}_{i-1}))$ 
6:     if  $c(\mathbf{x}_i) \geq \max(c(\mathbf{x}_{i-1}), \dots, c(\mathbf{x}_{i-\beta}))$  then
7:       break
8:     if  $c(\mathbf{x}_i) \leq \gamma$  then
9:       break
10:  return  $[\arg \min_{\mathbf{x}_i} (c(\mathbf{x}_i)), \min_{\mathbf{x}_i} (c(\mathbf{x}_i))]$ 
```

---

---

**Algorithm 2** Processing function for stacked DAE.

---

```
function PROCESS-DAE( $\mathbf{x}$ )
   $\mathbf{enc} \leftarrow \text{encoder.DECODE}(\mathbf{x})$ 
   $\mathbf{x} \leftarrow \text{NLMEANSDENOISE}(\mathbf{x})$ 
   $\mathbf{x} \leftarrow \text{SHARPEN}(\mathbf{x})$ 
  return  $\text{encoder.ENCODE}(\text{vec} \mathbf{x})$ 
```

---



- But... ?

# Privacy attack $\Rightarrow$ DP

A mechanism  $K$  achieves  $\epsilon$ -differential privacy if for all databases  $D_1, D_2$  differing in at most one row, and all  $S \subseteq \text{Range}(K)$ ,

$$\Pr[K(D_1) \in S] \leq \exp(\epsilon) \times \Pr[K(D_2) \in S]$$

Differential Privacy can use raw private data as input, either output a new dataset with adding some perturbation or a trained model to achieve the differential privacy rules.